

The First Amendment Bill to the Indian Constitution was presented in 1951 through which Articles 15, 19, 85, 87, 174, 176, 341, 342, 372, 376 were amended and two new Articles 31(a) and 31(b) and 9th Schedule was added to the Constitution.

4. Which of the following Constitutional Amendment Acts was termed as Mini Constitution?

- (a) 42nd (b) 44th
(c) 46th (d) 50th

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

Several provisions of the Constitution were altered, and several new provisions were added by 42nd Constitutional Amendment in 1976. So it is also termed as mini Constitution. The main objective of 42nd Constitutional Amendment was to overcome the difficulties arising from the decision of the Supreme Court in Keshavananda Bharati Case 1973. The Supreme Court made it clear in its judgment that certain features of the Constitution are so essential that they cannot be abrogated from the Constitution of India.

Official Language

1. Which Article of the Indian Constitution prescribes Hindi in Devanagari script as the official language of the Union?

- (a) 341 (b) 342
(c) 343 (d) 346
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (c)

Article 343(1) Part XVII of Indian Constitution is written that the official language of the union shall be Hindi in Devanagari Script. The form of numerals to be used for the official purposes of the union shall be the International form of Indian numerals.

2. The number of official languages recognised by the constitution in the eight schedule is.....

- (a) 16 (b) 17
(c) 18 (d) 20

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (*)

Before 92nd Constitution Amendment Act, 2003 there were total 18 languages in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution which increased to 22 after 92nd Constitution Amendment Act.

Panchayati Raj and Community Development

1. Which one of the following was established as the first programme of community development?

- (a) Cooperation Movement
(b) National Extension Service
(c) Integrated Rural Development Programme
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

The Community Development Programme (CDP) was the first major rural development programme launched after independence in 1952. Core objective of this program was to bring community development. The three phases of community development were National Extension Phase, Intensive Community Development Project Phase and Post-Intensive Development Phase. It is worth mentioning here that the National Extension Service program was formulated in April 1953 and it was inaugurated in October, 1953. It was formed after the Indian government realized that the Community Development Programme, which was formed in 1952, cannot be implemented all over India due to a shortage of funds.

2. The minimum age for contesting elections to the Panchayati Raj Institutions should be how many years according to the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act?

- (a) 18 years (b) 21 years
(c) 25 years (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Decentralization is the process in which Power is divided in many units. As for the local self government's structure in India, Panchayati Raj Institution is a system of local self-government in rural areas of the Indian subcontinent. Local Self-Government helps in the management of local affairs. It is important to mention here that such local bodies have representatives who have been elected by the local people and hence have a better understanding of grassroot level issues. Thus, the minimum age that a person should have for contesting elections is 21 years. The 73rd Amendment added Part IX to the constitution of India and was titled "The Panchayats". Furthermore, Part IXA of the constitution, titled "The Municipalities", was added by the 74th Amendment.